



PROJECT PROPOSAL & COSTING

Pan-African stays, visa-free travel.

A Booking.com-style marketplace for African stays, with a government-partnered Visa-Free Pass — built for African payment rails.

Prepared by

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Date

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Live prototype

iviwemalotana.github.io/afritravel

THE OPPORTUNITY

Travel within Africa is booming — but the tools aren't built for it

- **Payments don't fit.** Global platforms lean on cards; Africans pay with Mobile Money, USSD and local rails.
- **Inventory is thin.** Local stays are under-listed and priced in the wrong currencies.
- **Visas are friction.** Free-movement blocs (AfCFTA, ECOWAS, EAC, SADC) exist, but travellers don't know their rights and borders aren't digital.

The wedge

One platform that lists African stays, accepts **Paystack & Mobile Money**, and issues a **digital Visa-Free Pass** in partnership with governments — so booking a trip and crossing the border happen in one place.

54 markets

7+ currencies

Gov-partnered

THE PRODUCT

Four portals, one marketplace

Travellers

Search & book stays across Africa, pay with Paystack or Mobile Money, manage trips.

Visa-Free Pass

Register once, get an instantly-approved digital border pass with a scannable code.

Merchants

Hosts list properties, manage bookings & calendars, and receive payouts.

Admin

Platform health: inventory, transactions, KYC, fraud & compliance oversight.

Payments

Paystack (card/USSD/bank) + MTN/Airtel/M-Pesa Mobile Money, multi-currency.

Governments

Immigration partners verify passes — the rails for digital free movement.

NOT A CONCEPT — A WORKING PROTOTYPE

The product is already live today

- All four portals built and navigable
- Stay search, filtering, listing detail & live price quoting
- End-to-end booking with Paystack & Mobile Money (demo mode)
- Visa-Free Pass registration → issued digital pass with scannable code
- Built on the production stack: Vite · TypeScript · AWS-ready

Built in days, not months — de-risks the estimate below.



Try it now

iviwemalotana.github.io/afritravel

Live · public · responsive

SCOPE OF WORK

From prototype to production, in four phases

PHASE	WHAT GETS BUILT	OUTCOME
1 • Foundations	Database, API, auth (Cognito), admin CRUD, CI/CD, live data	Real accounts & live inventory
2 • Payments	Live Paystack + MoMo, webhooks, booking states, merchant payouts, receipts	Money moves · Soft launch
3 • Marketplace depth	Photos, calendars & dynamic pricing, search/maps, reviews, host onboarding + KYC	Self-serve marketplace
4 • Visa-Free Pass	Government rule engine, verifiable passes, immigration integration, trip planner	The differentiator · Public launch

Phases are independently shippable — the client can pause, reorder, or stop after any phase.

PROPOSED TIMELINE

~25 weeks to full public launch



Solo senior developer, part-time client check-ins. A second engineer can compress this by ~35%.

WHO'S BUILDING IT

Iviwe Malotana

The logo consists of the letters 'IM' in a bold, white, sans-serif font, centered within a dark teal square with rounded corners.

Full-Stack AI-Enabled Developer & Product Owner · Cape Town · BSc Electrical & Computer Engineering, UCT

- **7+ years** shipping web products end-to-end — database to interface, and the product decisions in between.
- **Fintech-hardened:** built payment, billing, recurring-card & fraud-detection systems handling *live customer money*.
- **Multi-tenant SaaS** with role-based permissions, webhooks & event-driven integrations — the exact shape of AfriTravel.
- Currently building a multi-tenant AI platform (React 19 + TypeScript front end, Python on AWS).

TypeScript / React

Python · AWS Lambda

DynamoDB · Cognito

Stripe / Paddle billing

Webhooks · Event-driven

Fraud & compliance

Figma · UX/UI

CI/CD · Playwright

Build fee by phase

PHASE	DURATION	ZAR	≈ USD
1 · Foundations	6 weeks	R110,000	\$5,950
2 · Payments	5 weeks	R100,000	\$5,400
3 · Marketplace depth	8 weeks	R140,000	\$7,600
4 · Visa-Free Pass	6 weeks	R90,000	\$4,860
Total build	~25 weeks	R440,000	\$23,800

 **Launch-ready start:** Phases 1–2 get you live and taking payments for **R210,000** (~\$11,350). Later phases on approval.

 **Care plan (post-launch):** R15,000–22,000/mo (~\$810–1,190) — fixes, updates, small features, monitoring.

Fixed per-phase fees, billed on milestone sign-off. Estimates; final scope confirmed at discovery. Excludes the running costs on the next slide.

Running costs (paid directly to providers)

Cloud hosting — AWS

MVP / launch traffic	\$180–320/mo
Growth (~50k bookings/mo)	\$900–1,500/mo

Payment processing (pass-through)

Paystack — local	~1.5% + small flat
Paystack — international	~3.9%
Mobile Money collections	~1–2%

Other services

Domain (.com / .africa)	\$15–40/yr
Transactional email/SMS	within AWS (~\$5–20/mo)
SSL certificate	Free (AWS ACM)
Error monitoring (optional)	~\$26/mo
Maps/geocoding (if used)	usage-based
Mobile app stores (Phase 5)	\$99/yr + \$25 once

Payment fees scale with sales (a cost of revenue), not a fixed bill. Hosting scales with traffic.
Detailed AWS breakdown in *docs/AWS_COSTS.md*.

THE NUMBERS AT A GLANCE

Total cost of ownership — year one

One-time build (full)

R440k

~\$23,800 · Phases 1–4

Hosting · year one

~\$3k

MVP tier, scales with traffic

Care plan · year one

~R220k

~\$11,900 · optional, post-launch

Phased entry to control cash flow

Start at **R210k** (Phases 1–2) to go live and take real bookings. Fund Phases 3–4 from early revenue. Payment fees only kick in once you're earning.

HOW BILLING WORKS

Milestone-based payment schedule

MILESTONE	TRIGGER	% OF PHASE
Kickoff deposit	Discovery sign-off, work begins	30%
Mid-phase review	Core features demoed	40%
Phase acceptance	Deployed & signed off	30%

✓ Each phase invoiced independently — no large upfront lock-in.

✓ Running costs (AWS, payments, domain) billed directly to the company's own accounts — full transparency, no markup.

NEXT STEPS

Let's build the rails for African travel.

- Book a discovery session to lock scope & the Phase-1 statement of work
- Confirm payment-provider & (later) government partnerships
- Kickoff within 1–2 weeks of sign-off

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Portfolio

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Live demo

iviwemalotana.github.io/afritravel